

Pronunciation

B C D F G H J L M N P R S T V W Y

C = /k/ (cake) · H = /h/ or soft rasp · J = /dʒ/ (jello) · R = /r/ flap (American butter)

Vowels: A /ɑ/ (father) · E /ɛ/ (cellar) · I /i/ (creek) · O /ɔ/ (door) · U /u/ (flu)

E and O closed like Spanish are fine too.

Stress: penultimate syllable — iLlru

1. Pronouns and Possession

	singular	plural
1st	nim I	nima we
2nd	run you	runa you (pl)
3rd	hay he / she / they	haya they (pl)

Pronouns are often dropped when context is clear. Affirmative sentences default to nim, and questions to run, so you don't repeat them as much as in English.

Possessive: pronoun before the word · for nouns, use de

nim bo = my house
bo de miwo = dog's house

2. The Four Core Markers

a [subject] · i [verb] · e [direct object] · u [indirect object]

Mnemonics: Actor · Initiates · Engaged · Unto

a nim i anona e mocen u run
I give chocolate to you

More often (nim dropped in affirmative): i anona e mocen u run

You may drop markers when context is clear. a drops the easiest, and then e.

a...a means is / are:

a hay a yalen = he/she/they is tall · a bo a yamirli = the house is old
Word order is flexible because roles are marked: e mocen u run i anona is also common.

3. Describing Words

A modifier goes right before the word it describes.

mocen mouje = chocolate drink
pohem mocen mouje = hot chocolate drink

4. Two Core Prepositions

en = location / time ("in, on, at")

de = source / possession ("of, from")

a run en bo = you are at home
a hay i anifi de bo = he/she/they comes from the house

5. Coordination and Contrast

su	and / with	run i mo e moaria su mocen	you eat apple and chocolate
mai	but	hay i anvu, mai nim i doum	she goes, but I don't
dou	or	nim i mo e moaria dou mocen	I eat apple or chocolate
eta	so, therefore	a nim a tou, eta nim i bonfene	I'm tired, so I lie down

6. Negation

Add -um to the word you want to negate.

i dami a moaria = there is an apple
i damium a moaria = there is no apple

7. Questions and "what/that" Clauses

Raise intonation for yes/no questions. No structural change.

run i mo? = are you eating?

ce = what (question) · ca = that / which (connector)

ce en bo? = what's in the house?

Build more question words with ce + a domain word:

word	meaning
cei	who (what + person)
cedom	where (what + place)
celi	when (what + time)
ceora	why (what + reason)
cenon	how (what + way)

In statements, swap ce → ca: ceora → caora (because) · cedom → cadom (where) · etc.

run i ilianum cadom bo = you know-not where the house

8. Verb Stacking

To chain two verbs, repeat i before each one. No "to" needed.

run i dairan i anelem en bo = you like to stay home
hay i do i mo = he/she/they can eat
haya i dai i anvu = they want to go

9. Compounds

To make compounds, attach -s to the end of every word except for the last. Sol is an optional indicator of the start of a compound.

sol was jasru	wa (sea) + jasru (bend)	= bay
sol lufus bei	lufu (air) + bei (vehicle)	= airplane
sol yalgais mus	yalgai (small) + mus (bug)	= ant
sol was dom	wa (sea) + dom (land)	= island

Hyphenated forms fuse two words into one expression:

tohpu-vanvu	tohpu (sad) + vanvu (walk)	= to trudge
bo-bortal	bo (house) + bortal (enter)	= to enter a house

If you're unsure which form to use, just use whatever feels right. Chances are, either works!

10. Vocabulary

Most Oravia words are formed as (sub)cluster + root. A cluster is the first sound(s) and signals the semantic domain; a root adds a second layer of meaning.

moalen (banana) = MO (food) + A (fruit subcluster) + LEN (root: long)

~260 (sub)clusters and roots were discovered using word-embeddings. Once you know the patterns, you can make educated guesses and learn words faster.

Starter Vocabulary

mo	eat / food	bo	house	beivu	car	leirih	tree
falen	child	fare	parent	faeior	woman	faejal	man
faibor	spouse	eofa	friend	ilhei	person	anye	make, do
anvu	go	anona	give	anifou	need	ando	can
none	have	anidai	want	dami	exist	dairan	like
ilian	know	ilaluan	speak	elemi	live, life	yuba	good
ti	bad	yalen	tall/long	litam	day	liyar	morning
noli	now	noi	here / this	ho noi	there / that	oipoh	exciting

	AN	action <i>PIE *h₂en- (to breathe live)</i>		ELI	virtue <i>Greek θικός (ethikos = ethical)</i>		ILO	when knowledge is uncertain <i>English illusion</i>
	ANE	static movement <i>Latin manere (to remain stay)</i>		ELO	prosocal <i>Latin eloqui (to speak out)</i>		JA	tools <i>Arabic jīhāz (apparatus, equipment)</i>
	ANI	movement towards <i>Latin animus (directed will)</i>		EO	social <i>Greek ε - (eu = good, social prefix)</i>		JAE	container <i>Arabic jarra (large container)</i>
	ANO	movement away <i>Japanese ano (that, over there)</i>		EOD	social interactions <i>Japanese deau (meet)</i>		JAH	cutting tools <i>Japanese (ha ja = blade, edge)</i>
	APA	physical movement <i>Sanskrit apad (to move on foot)</i>		EOM	events and gatherings <i>Korean moim (gathering, meeting)</i>		JAS	gripping and fastening tools <i>Japanese hasamu (clamp, pinch)</i>
	AS	involuntary bodily functions <i>PIE *h₂es- (to be, to exist)</i>		FA	family relationships <i>Latin familia (family)</i>		JE	geometrics <i>Mandarin (jié = joint, geometric section)</i>
	ASE	affectionate contact <i>Sanskrit āśle a (embrace, close contact)</i>		FAE	gender		JEN	location <i>Japanese (zen jen front location)</i>
	ASI	orifice intake and expulsion <i>Sanskrit āśya (mouth)</i>		FAI	partnership, marriage <i>Latin foedus (pact, partnership)</i>		JEO	geometric positions <i>Greek yew- geo (geography, geometry)</i>
	ASU	involuntary vocal acts <i>Sanskrit asu (breath, vital force)</i>		FAL	young ones <i>Latin filia, filius (children)</i>		JIM	urgency <i>Mandarin (jí jí (urgent, anxious, rapid)</i>
	BE	travel <i>Bengali berano (to roam, travel)</i>		FE	halting <i>Turkish fren (brake)</i>		JO	materials <i>Korean jaeryo (material)</i>
	BEI	vehicles		FEI	less		JOL	material types
	BO	home interior <i>Arabic (bayt = house, dwelling)</i>		FENE	rest		JU	deceive <i>Hindi jhū h (lie, deception)</i>
	BOE	house spaces <i>English bower (private room)</i>		FI	inside <i>Swahili -fika (to arrive, come)</i>		JUI	temporary <i>Hindi jugā (makeshift, temporary)</i>
	BON	furniture <i>French banc (bench, table-like furniture)</i>		FIVA	cold		LA	happiness <i>cross-linguistic (happiness expression)</i>
	BOR	house structure <i>English bore board (structural element)</i>		FOU	lack <i>English few</i>		LAN	balance <i>Hindi sa tulana (balance, equilibrium)</i>
	BOS	hygiene fixtures <i>Malay basuh (to wash)</i>		FU	lightness <i>Mandarin fú (floating, light)</i>		LANO	around
	CAI	flat <i>Sanskrit caya (flat layer)</i>		GA	evaluation <i>English gauge</i>		LARO	continuation
	CATI	constraint <i>Latin catena (chain, constraint)</i>		GAI	small <i>English grain of sand</i>		LE	environment <i>PIE *lendh- (open land, heath)</i>
	CE	what? <i>Latin quid (what) and Romance que ce</i>		GAIRA	fungus		LEA	landscape <i>English lea (open meadow)</i>
	CI	sharp <i>Mandarin cì (to stab, prick, sharp)</i>		GAN	ranking <i>Japanese gan (rank, grade)</i>		LEI	plants <i>Mandarin (lěi = flower bud, plant growth)</i>
	CIU	creative products <i>English creative, Latin creatus</i>		GAO	centered		LEM	keeping <i>Greek lēmma (something taken, kept)</i>
	CO	communication <i>Latin communicare (to communicate)</i>		GAR	bear		LEN	long <i>Latin longus (long)</i>
	COU	written communication <i>French courier (mail, correspondence)</i>		GE	finances <i>Proto-Germanic *geldan (to pay)</i>		LENO	ground <i>Spanish llano (flat ground)</i>
	CUI	concavity		GEH	sales <i>German gelten (to be worth, trade)</i>		LEO	belonging
	DA	evaluation <i>Arabic dhā (this, that, referential)</i>		GI	boldness <i>Hindi jigar (courage, heart)</i>		LI	time <i>Mandarin lì (calendar)</i>
	DAC	impact		GO	half <i>Japanese go (five, half of ten)</i>		LIA	resonant <i>Hindi laya (rhythm, resonance)</i>
	DAE	epistemic <i>Japanese dai (declaration, evidence)</i>		GOR	firm		LIL	muscle <i>Arabic līf (fiber)</i>
	DAI	desire		HAI	message <i>Swahili habari (news, message)</i>		LIMEL	evening <i>Arabic layl (night)</i>
	DAL	pattern <i>Swahili dalili (sign, indication, pattern)</i>		HE	fiction tropes <i>Greek ηῆρς (heros = hero, trope figure)</i>		LIRA	mark <i>Latin littera (letter, mark)</i>
	DAN	emphasis <i>Mandarin (dàn = but, emphatic contrast)</i>		HEH	antagonist tropes <i>English hex</i>		LITE	clock time <i>Greek λεπτό λεπτο (minute)</i>
	DAO	serious		HEI	protagonist tropes		LIU	other <i>Latin alius (other)</i>
	DAU	distance		HELA	projecting outward <i>Sanskrit hel (to throw, sport)</i>		LOA	completeness <i>Hawaiian loa (very much, extremely)</i>
	DE	origin, from <i>Latin de (from, down from)</i>		HEM	warmth		LOR	benefit
	DEL	logic <i>Latin delineare (to draw out logically)</i>		HEO	background <i>Old English heofon (sky vault)</i>		LU	weather and atmosphere <i>Latin lux (light, sky phenomenon)</i>
	DETU	end		HICA	story		LUA	flow <i>Arabic lujja (deep flowing water)</i>
	DI	stripe, finger <i>Sanskrit diś (direction, to point)</i>		HO	opposite		LUAN	tongue <i>Arabic lisān (tongue)</i>
	DO	regulations <i>Mandarin (dào = way, rule, principle)</i>		HOH	extreme		LUFU	air <i>German Luft (air)</i>
	DOH	enforcement <i>Hausa dokar (regulation)</i>		HOU	shadow <i>Mandarin hòu (behind, back)</i>		LUN	seasons <i>Latin luna (moon, seasonal cycle)</i>
	DOI	opposing <i>Arabic idd (opposing, against)</i>		HUCU	command <i>Indonesian hukum (law)</i>		LUO	practice
	DOM	place <i>Latin domus (house, place, domain)</i>		HUE	haze		MA	cooking food <i>Arabic (matbakh = kitchen)</i>
	DON	show		HUI	ethereal <i>Mandarin hún (soul, spirit)</i>		MAE	tubers and grains <i>Mandarin (mí = rice, grain)</i>
	DORA	bond <i>Latin adorare (to be bound in devotion)</i>		IL	objects of inquiry <i>Latin ille (that thing, object of inquiry)</i>		MAI	contrast
	DUR	hardness <i>Latin durus (hard, tough)</i>		ILA	sharing information <i>Arabic (ilā = toward, sharing direction)</i>		MAL	bread and dairy <i>German Mehl (flour)</i>
	ELA	religious <i>Aramaic Elah (God)</i>		ILI	cognition <i>Portuguese inteligencia (intelligence)</i>		MAS	spices and seasonings <i>Arabic (masāla = spice blend)</i>
	ELE	self-expansion <i>Greek eleutheros (free, self-expansion)</i>						

●	MEL	night
●●	MI	bigger animals <i>Swahili mnyama (bigger animals)</i>
●	MIA	mixing
●	MIE	appearance <i>Mandarin miàn (face, appearance)</i>
●	MIN	pleasure
●	MIO	wild animals <i>Hindi m g (wild animal)</i>
●	MIR	lots of <i>Sanskrit mīr (leader of many)</i>
●	MIU	support
●●	MO	food, eating <i>Hawaiian moku (to eat, archaic)</i>
●	MOA	fruits <i>Polynesian moa (banana plant)</i>
●	MOL	food containers
●●	MU	smaller animals <i>Swahili mdudu (insect, bug)</i>
●	MUH	flying animals <i>Persian morgh (bird)</i>
●	MUS	bug
●	NA	giving <i>Hindi denā (to give)</i>
●●	NE	quantifiers <i>Swahili na (additive marker)</i>
●	NEN	power and violence <i>Latin imponens (imposing)</i>
●	NEVI	deserve
●	NI	new <i>Hindi nayā (new)</i>
●	NIU	some <i>Tagalog niyon niyun (that)</i>
●●	NO	function words <i>Latin non (negation)</i>
●	NON	path
●	NOR	relation to reference <i>Latin norma (standard, reference point)</i>
●	NOU	low, falling <i>Arabic nawm (sleep, falling into sleep)</i>
●	NU	limit <i>Greek nu (particle marking limits)</i>
●	NYA	empty <i>Sanskrit śūnya (nothingness, emptiness)</i>
●	ODO	business
●	ODU	top
●	OI	fun <i>English joy</i>
●	OM	music <i>Sanskrit om (primordial sound)</i>
●	ORA	idea
●	PA	paper <i>Latin papyrus (paper)</i>
●	PAI	foot <i>Hindi pair (foot)</i>
●	PAN	achievement
●	PARO	front <i>Latin pro prae (in front of, before)</i>
●	PAS	favor
●	PILI	delicate
●	PO	components <i>English portion</i>
●	POA	chemical
●●	POH	energy <i>Greek πῦρ (pyr = fire)</i>
●	POI	liquids
●	POPO	echo <i>onomatopoeia for hollow resonance echo</i>
●	PU	loss, sadness <i>Persian pūc (emptiness, loss)</i>
●	PUPI	water falling <i>onomatopoeia for falling water</i>

●	RA	society <i>Sanskrit rastra (state, polity, society)</i>
●	RAI	governance <i>Hindi (rāj = rule, governance)</i>
●	RAM	sudden <i>Latin raptim (suddenly, rapidly)</i>
●	RAN	media, public discourse <i>Hindi ra gmanç (public stage)</i>
●	RAS	about society <i>Arabic rasm (social practice)</i>
●	REL	up, high <i>Latin relevare (to lift, raise up)</i>
●	REN	honor <i>Mandarin rén (benevolence, honor)</i>
●	REVA	accurate <i>Latin revelare (to reveal)</i>
●	RI	act
●	RIH	higher, rising
●●	RO	knowledge <i>Japanese ron (argument, theory)</i>
●	ROE	formal education <i>Latin rogare (formally proposing)</i>
●	ROS	tense, tight
●	ROU	written knowledge <i>Latin rotulus (scroll, written scroll)</i>
●	RU	bend <i>Arabic rukū (bowing, bending)</i>
●	RUL	habit <i>English rule</i>
●	SABA	enable
●	SAR	hang <i>Turkish sarkmak (to hang down)</i>
●	SARI	sun <i>Sanskrit sūrya (sun)</i>
●	SAU	start <i>Hindi śūrū (start, beginning)</i>
●	SE	machines <i>Mandarin (shèbèi = equipment)</i>
●	SEL	coding <i>English select, cell</i>
●	SEM	system <i>Greek αἰσθημα systema (system)</i>
●	SERI	series <i>Latin series (sequence, series)</i>
●	SI	processes <i>PIE *sek- (follow a sequence)</i>
●	SIO	games <i>Latin iocus (game, jest, play)</i>
●	SIU	written record
●	SOI	speed <i>Vietnamese sớm (soon, early)</i>
●	SU	alongside
●	SUS	rustling sound
●	TA	hand <i>Latin tangere (to touch with hand)</i>
●	TAI	guide <i>Mandarin dài (lead)</i>
●	TAL	door <i>Persian āq (arch, doorway)</i>
●	TALE	passage <i>Welsh taith (journey, passage)</i>
●	TAM	one <i>Arabic tamām (whole, one complete)</i>
●	TAN	big <i>Greek títan (giant)</i>
●	TAR	regulate <i>Arabic tartīb (regulation, arrangement)</i>
●	TEL	image <i>English television</i>
●	TELI	moment
●	TER	count <i>Latin ter (three times)</i>
●●	TI	harm, damage <i>Tamil (ti = fire, harm, danger)</i>
●	TIU	types of harm <i>Sanskrit (tīvra = severe, violent)</i>
●●	TO	suffering, distress <i>Indonesian tobat (remorse, suffering)</i>
●	TOH	emotional suffering <i>English torment</i>

●	TOS	interpersonal suffering <i>Greek pathos (suffering, passion)</i>
●	TOU	physical depletion
●	TU	conflict <i>Latin tumultus (conflict, violent disorder)</i>
●	TUL	crash <i>English tumble</i>
●	TUM	weapons <i>Indonesian tombak (spear weapon)</i>
●	VA	core <i>Sanskrit (vāyu = vital wind breath)</i>
●	VABO	cozy, body home <i>va (body) + bo (home)</i>
●	VAL	ice <i>Italian valanga (snow mass)</i>
●	VAN	limbs <i>Hindi (bā h = arm limb)</i>
●●	VAR	face <i>Sanskrit vaktram (face mouth)</i>
●	VARI	back <i>Arabic warā (behind, back)</i>
●	VAS	private
●	VEI	health issues <i>Sanskrit vaidya (physician)</i>
●	VEL	medical treatments <i>Latin valere (to be well healthy)</i>
●	VENI	granulated
●	VER	safety <i>German Wehr (defense, protection)</i>
●●	VI	interior body <i>Latin vita (life force, interior body)</i>
●	VIO	change, exchange <i>Latin via (road, path of change)</i>
●	VIR	method <i>Sanskrit vrt (procedure)</i>
●	VIS	organs <i>Latin viscera (internal organs)</i>
●	VOA	constraint <i>Mandarin wéi (enclose, surround)</i>
●	VON	external body
●	VOR	threat <i>English horror</i>
●●	VOS	cleaning actions <i>Vietnamese v (cover, shell, skin)</i>
●	VU	movement <i>Mandarin bù (step, pace)</i>
●	VUSON	slow movement <i>vu (move) + son (late)</i>
●●	WA	water, sea <i>Polynesian root wai (water)</i>
●	WI	geographical orientation <i>Arabic (wayn = where?)</i>
●	WIL	human made geography <i>Latin villa (human settlement)</i>
●	WIM	natural geography
●	WOL	wide
●	WOWO	oscillate
●●	YA	objective qualities
●	YAH	texture qualities
●●	YAL	size qualities <i>Arabic awil (long, tall, length)</i>
●	YAR	light <i>Arabic iyā (radiant light)</i>
●	YE	clothing and fabric <i>Turkish yelken (sail, large fabric)</i>
●	YEL	joining <i>English yoke</i>
●	YEN	printed <i>Mandarin yìn (stamp, print mark)</i>
●	YES	garments
●	YI	sweet
●●	YO	colors <i>Yoruba y (to emerge)</i>
●	YOL	sky and ocean
●	YU	subjective qualities
●	YUN	personal characteristics